

Discussion - Leading AI Transformation in Academic Departments: Strategies for Chairs and School Directors

Hongchi Shi – Texas State University

Traian Marius Truta – Northern Kentucky University



AI Adoption is Growing among students and instructors

According to Gray DI, a strategy and software firm focused on enhancing decision-making in higher education:

- Students adopted AI tools quickly
- Instructors are catching up to students
- 86% of students and 85% instructors used AI in 2024/25
- Healthy skepticism remains

Challenges and Opportunities are abundant in leading AI transformation in academic departments

- The role computing departments/schools play in AI-forward institutions
- Declining enrollment in computing due to perception of AI replacing entry-level jobs
- Preparing students for an AI-driven future
- Grade inflation and student cheating using AI tools
- Limited financial and human resources for AI transformation
